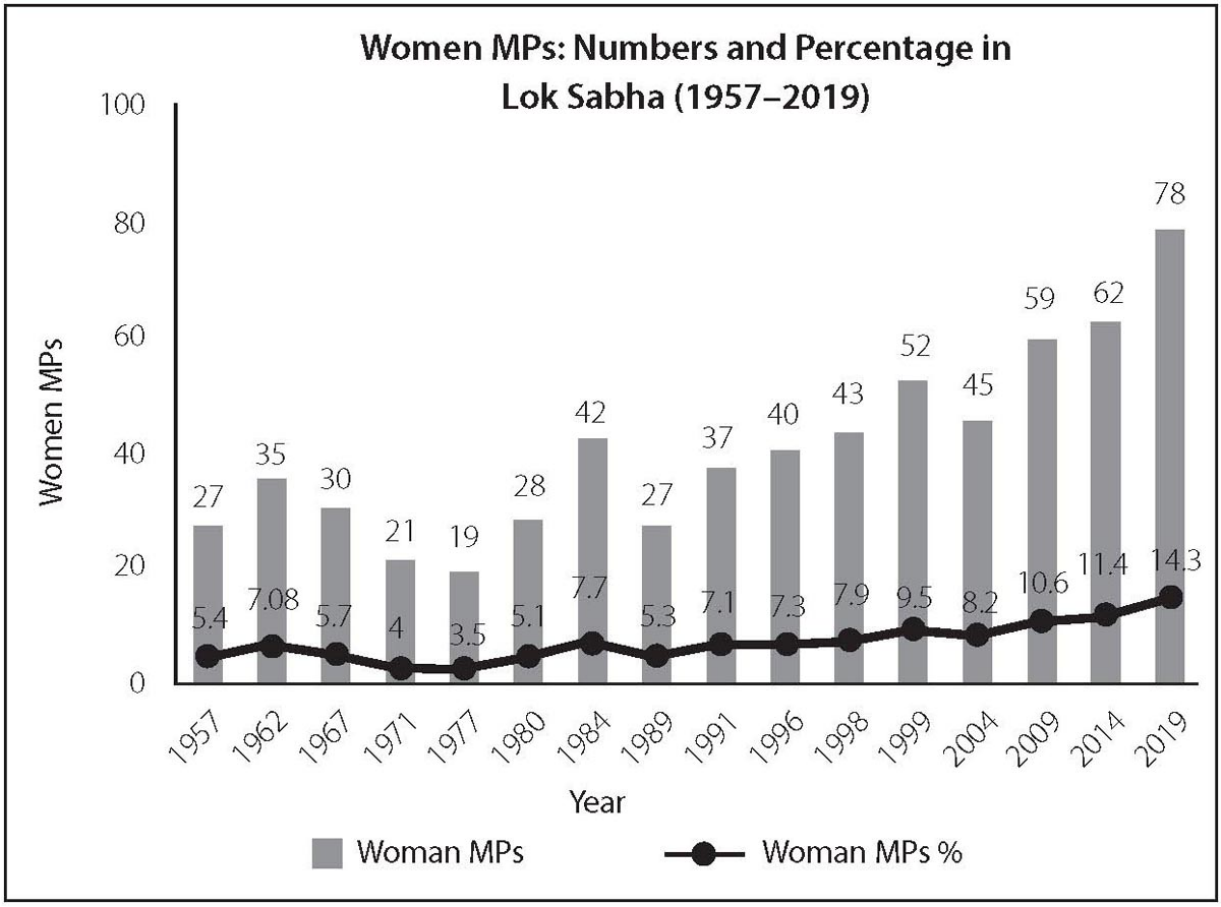


Source: Social Statistics Division, National Statistical Office, Women and Men in India: A Statistical Compilation of Gender Related Indicators in India, 21st Issue (New Delhi: Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation, Government of India, 2019), p. 102. Research inputs by Rajesh Sharma.

In fact, Modi's second year in power, 2015, saw the ratio of women ministers rising to 17.8 per cent. Government data shows that this was the highest ever share of women ministers since gender statistics started being counted in 1985. Since then, the share of women ministers under Modi has fallen somewhat. Yet, women's share on average still remains higher than in the Congress governments (see Figures 17.8 and 17.9). Furthermore, from the late Sushma Swaraj as foreign affairs minister (2014–2019) to Smriti Irani as human resources minister in NDA-1 and Nirmala Sitharaman as defence minister and then finance minister (from 2017 onwards), women have held major portfolios in the two Modi governments.